Walt

Europe reclaims tap-to-pay

The Problem

Two US companies control every tap

Duopoly scale

1.0–1.3B
combined users globally

€8.3T
in digital wallet transactions (2025)

Everyone else

<0.4% combined market share. No privacy-first NFC wallet exists.

Apple Pay

Charges banks 0.15% per transaction — an invisible tax on European commerce.

Google Wallet

Harvests every transaction for ad profiles. Extracts €15–30 per active user per year in advertising value.

Curve Pay

Biometric scans, geo-location, behavioral tracking retained 10 years. Shared with ad companies.

Sources: CoinLaw, WSJ / DOJ, StatCounter, Curve Privacy Policy (Jan 2026)

Solution

Privacy-first European tap-to-pay

B2C

Walt App

- €10/year subscription — the user is the customer, not the product
- On-device encryption: transaction data never leaves the phone
- No backend server required — hardware-backed keys protect all data

B2B2C

Walt for Banks

- Whitelabel tap-to-pay for banks wanting to reduce Apple/Google dependency
- Banks keep customer relationship — Walt provides privacy infrastructure

Cross-platform via DMA

- Android: native HCE (Host Card Emulation)
- iPhone: iOS 17.4+ NFC access via 10-year DMA mandate across all EEA
- Uses Face ID / Touch ID for authentication
- Can be set as default payment app

Privacy guarantee

Walt never touches PAN/CVC data. All sensitive operations handled by certified MeaWallet SDK. No tracking. No ads. No data sales. Ever.

Why Now?

Four regulatory waves opening the market

JULY 2024

Digital Markets Act

EU forced Apple to open NFC to third-party wallets for **10 years** across all 30 EEA countries. Apple subsequently extended globally. First time a privacy alternative can exist.

LATE 2026

eIDAS 2.0 & EUDI

All 27 EU member states must offer digital identity wallets. Privacy-by-design mandated. Normalizes non-Big-Tech wallets for 450M Europeans.

2027–2028

PSR / PSD3

Payment Services Regulation harmonizes authentication and levels the playing field between bank and non-bank payment providers.

~2029

Digital Euro

ECB's CBDC uses NFC tap-to-pay on existing terminals. Bypasses Visa/Mastercard entirely. Offline mode offers cash-like privacy. €1.3B build cost.

Sources: European Commission, ECB, Council of the EU

Product Deep-Dive

How Walt tap-to-pay actually works

HCE Architecture

Host Card Emulation — software-based card emulation on both Android and iPhone. No secure element dependency. Works on any modern smartphone.

MeaWallet Token Platform

I-TSP certified for Visa, Mastercard, and Amex. 200+ institutions across 50+ countries already onboarded. Walt integrates their SDK — never touches card data directly.

On-device Encryption

All transaction data encrypted with hardware-backed keys and stays on-device. No cloud sync. No server-side processing. PCI DSS likely does not apply to Walt directly.

Security Model

- MeaWallet SDK handles PAN encryption & transmission
- Walt's code never sees PAN/CVC
- Biometric auth via device OS (Face ID / fingerprint)
- Double-click side button to invoke on iPhone

Platform Support

ANDROID	IPHONE
Native HCE, available today	iOS 17.4+ via DMA NFC access

Challenges

Tokenization approval chain

I-TSP vs. TR-TSP

MeaWallet acts as Issuer Token Service Provider with pre-approved certification. Several hundred issuers already onboarded — for those banks, Walt tokenization works without re-negotiation.

Bank Approval Chain

- **Layer 1:** Card scheme certification (Visa/Mastercard)
- **Layer 2:** Payment processors (Nets/Nexi serves 250+ Nordic banks; Tietoevry serves 90+)
- **Layer 3:** Individual issuing bank approval

MeaWallet vs. Fidesmo

MeaWallet (primary): Proven I-TSP with hundreds of issuers. Integration-ready today.

Fidesmo (alternative): Phone SDK expected summer 2026 with Mastercard. Pre-approved issuer network. Hedge if MeaWallet terms unfavorable.

Nordic Infrastructure

Danish IT cooperatives (Bankdata, BEC/BOKIS) are additional intermediaries. Processor partnerships are the key to scaling — one Nets/Nexi integration unlocks 250+ banks simultaneously.

The Market

15–30M privacy-active Europeans

TAM

€1.0–1.5B/year

100–150M “Privacy Active” Europeans (Eurostat: took at least one data protection step)

SAM

€150–300M/year

15–30M using multiple privacy tools simultaneously (encrypted email + privacy browser + VPN + secure messenger)

SOM (YEAR 1–3)

€1–5M/year

100K–500K paying users. GrapheneOS alone has 250K+ active users with zero NFC payment option.

Comparable privacy brands

- **Proton:** 100M+ accounts (30–40M Europe)
- **Signal:** 70M+ MAU (10–20M Europe)
- **Brave:** 101M MAU (10–12M Europe)
- **DuckDuckGo:** 100M daily searches

European sentiment

70% of Germans and 71% of French prefer European-based apps if feature/price parity with US alternatives.

Nordic momentum

Proton reported ~80% surge in Nordic signups following US–EU geopolitical tensions. Signal downloads surging across Nordics.

Sources: Eurostat, Proton (Feb 2026), company reports

Competitors

No privacy-first NFC competitor exists

Curve Pay

6M+ USERS · ACQUIRED BY LLOYDS (~£120M)

January 2026 privacy policy: biometric scans, geo-location, behavioral tracking. Data retained 10 years, shared with ad companies and social media platforms. Lloyds acquisition likely deprioritizes European expansion.

Revolut

60–65M USERS · £300M AD REVENUE TARGET

Active data monetization. Hired TikTok UK's former head of e-commerce to build advertising business by 2026. Users are the product.

Wero

50M+ REGISTERED · NFC PLANNED 2026–2027

Most dangerous near-term threat. Bank-backed, strong distribution. But weak privacy story and NFC point-of-sale not yet live. E-commerce only in Germany as of end-2025.

EUDI Wallet

MANDATED BY EIDAS 2.0 · LATE 2026

Strongest privacy-by-design framework (selective disclosure, on-device storage). But uses QR/SEPA Credit Transfer — not NFC tap-to-pay. Preserves Walt's UX advantage.

Traction & Roadmap

2–3 year head start before competitive terrain shifts

Today

400+

waitlist signups — strong demand signal from privacy communities

Break-even

3K–6K

paying users at €10/year covers solo operation costs (€30K/year)

Key unlock

Fidesmo phone SDK expected **summer 2026** — alternative tokenization path with pre-approved issuer network. Processor partnerships (Nets/Nexi, Tietoevry) unlock banks at scale.

Geographic expansion

- **Phase 1 — Finland:** Highest digital privacy index, strong privacy culture, Fidesmo HQ
- **Phase 2 — Nordics:** Denmark (63% iPhone), Norway, Sweden. High digital maturity, privacy awareness
- **Phase 3 — Germany:** Largest economy, most privacy-conscious EU nation (61.6% Android), 189+ digital independence organizations

Competitive window

- Wero NFC: 2026–2027
- EUDI rollout: late 2026
- Digital euro: ~2029
- **Walt's window: now through 2028**

The Ask

STATUS

Work in Progress

Still formulating the ask.

Networking Needs

- **Nordic payment infrastructure**
  Fidesmo, Nets/Nexi, Tietoevry
- **Nordic bank cards & payments leads**
  Nordea, Swedbank, DNB, Lunar, SpareBank 1
- **Visa & Mastercard Nordic fintech leads**
  Wallet certification contacts

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